

Learning & Development Policy

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TechV-Flash actively encourages continuous upskilling, professional certifications, and technical development. This policy outlines eligibility, annual budgets, reimbursement rules, and service commitments associated with company-funded learning initiatives.

1. Annual Learning Allowance & Eligibility

1.1 Eligibility Criteria

All Full-Time Employees who have successfully completed their 90-day probationary period are eligible for the Annual Learning Allowance. Part-Time Employees receive a 50% pro-rated benefit. Interns and employees currently on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) are not eligible for learning sponsorships.

Employee Level	Annual Allowance Limit	Permissible Categories
L1 - L3 (Engineers & Associates)	35,000 INR	Technical certifications (AWS, GCP, Azure, CKA), online courses (Coursera, Udemy Pro), technical books.
L4 - L5 (Leads & Managers)	60,000 INR	Advanced architecture certifications, agile/PMP credentials, leadership workshops, specialized tech bootcamps.
L6+ (Directors & Executives)	1,00,000 INR	Executive education, global conference registrations, executive coaching programs.

2. Pre-Approval & Reimbursement Process

2.1 Prior Written Approval

Employees must submit a Learning Plan Request on the HR Portal at least 10 business days prior to enrollment or exam scheduling. Reimbursement requests submitted without prior approval will be automatically rejected.

2.2 Proof of Completion & Passing Mandate

To claim reimbursement for certification exam vouchers, the employee must provide a passing certificate/scorecard along with the original tax invoice. In the event of an exam failure, the cost is borne entirely by the employee; second attempts are not subsidized.

2.3 Expense Submission Window

Invoices and certificates must be submitted via the expense portal within 30 calendar days of exam completion or course completion.

3. Service Retention Agreement (Clawback Clause)

Mandatory Retention Period: If TechV-Flash sponsors any single certification, specialized training, or executive program where total company expenditure exceeds 25,000 INR, a mandatory 12-month retention agreement applies from the date of certification completion.

3.1 Clawback Recovery Terms

If an employee voluntarily resigns within 6 months of completing a sponsored program exceeding 25,000 INR, 100% of the sponsored amount will be deducted during full and final settlement. For resignations occurring between 7 and 12 months, 50% of the sponsored cost will be recovered.

4. Study Leaves & Conference Attendance

4.1 Certification Study Leave

Eligible FTEs may avail up to 2 days of paid "Study Leave" per calendar year to prepare for and sit for approved high-impact technical certifications. Study leave requires at least 14 days of advance manager approval.

4.2 Tech Conference Sponsorship

Employees accepted as speakers at accredited technical conferences (e.g., PyCon, IEEE conferences, React Summit) will receive 100% travel and lodging sponsorship under the Travel Policy (HR-POL-006), separate from their individual learning allowance.

5. External Degree & Executive Education Sponsorship

5.1 Higher Education Criteria

Confirmed FTEs with at least 3 years of service can nominate themselves for executive programs or specialized master degrees (e.g., Executive MBA). The program must be run by a government-accredited university.

5.2 Approval Flow & Quota

Nominations are evaluated by the Executive Committee annually in January. Sponsoring is capped at a maximum of 5 employees per business unit, with funding approved up to 100% depending on role relevance.

5.3 Table of Executive Degree Sponsorship Slabs

Course / Degree Category	Maximum Funding Limit	Service Bond Period	Withdrawal/Failure Consequence
Executive MBA / PGDM	2,50,000 INR total	24 Months post degree completion	100% recovery of disbursed fees
Part-time Technical Masters (M.Tech/MS)	2,00,000 INR total	18 Months post degree completion	100% recovery of disbursed fees
Advanced Leadership Certifications (IIM/IIT)	1,20,000 INR total	12 Months post program completion	100% recovery of disbursed fees

6. Professional Body Memberships

6.1 Approved Associations

TechV-Flash supports membership in professional associations (e.g., IEEE, ACM, Scrum Alliance). Membership must offer access to research repositories, industry networking, and certification discounts.

6.2 Annual Reimbursement Limits

Reimbursement is capped at 1 association membership per calendar year per employee. Prior manager sign-off is required before payment.

6.3 Table of Professional Association Reimbursement

Association / Guild Category	Eligible Employee Grades	Annual Reimbursement Limit	Required Verification Documentation
Technical & Engineering Guilds (ACM, IEEE)	All L1 - L3 Engineering staff	8,000 INR per year	Annual membership invoice and digital card
Management & Agile Guilds (PMI, Scrum Alliance)	L4 - L5 Managers and Scrum Leads	12,000 INR per year	Annual membership invoice and digital card
Executive Forums (NASSCOM, CII)	L6+ Directors & Vice Presidents	25,000 INR per year	PR team approval notice, invoice and card

7. Corporate Academy & Internal Bootcamps

7.1 Internal Training Programs

The L&D team runs monthly classroom and virtual training cycles on soft skills, agile execution, and advanced tech stacks (e.g., Rust development, kubernetes orchestration). Attendance is tracked.

7.2 Cross-skilling Bootcamps

To facilitate project transitions, employees can enroll in 4-week internal tech bootcamps. Enrolling requires HOD approval and a commitment to clear the associated certification.

8. Knowledge Sharing (Brown Bag Sessions)

8.1 Knowledge Dissemination Goals

To foster peer learning, employees completing external certifications or bootcamps are expected to deliver a 45-minute technical session (Brown Bag) to their department.

8.2 Presenter Incentives

Delivering a brown bag session earns the presenter a 1,000 INR learning voucher, which can be applied to buy books or technical subscriptions, separate from the standard annual allowance.

9. Management & Leadership Development Programs

9.1 High-Potential (HiPo) Program

Quarterly, top performers are nominated by HODs for the HiPo Leadership Cohort. This cohort receives specialized management workshops, communications coaching, and executive mentorship.

9.2 Internal Mentorship Framework

Managers are paired with senior engineers to act as mentors. The framework requires monthly check-ins and target goal setting for career direction and technical depth.

10. Learning Audits & Compliance Requirements

10.1 Audit of Reimbursement Invoices

All expense claims undergo audits by the finance and HR compliance teams. Forged invoices or certificates will lead to disciplinary proceedings under HR-POL-015.

10.2 Mandatory Security & Compliance Courses

Apart from voluntary development, employees must clear the mandatory Information Security (HR-POL-007) and Data Privacy (LEG-POL-008) micro-courses annually within 30 days of release.

11. Travel Slabs for Sponsored Education

11.1 Travel to Learning Centers

When corporate-sponsored courses require physical attendance at national universities or outstation bootcamps, travel costs are funded as per the company Travel Policy (HR-POL-006).

11.2 Table of Travel Slabs for Learning Programs

Travel Location Category	Maximum Hotel Lodging Cap	Daily Meal Allowance per Diem	Additional Travel Approval Target
Tier 1 Cities (Mumbai, Bangalore, Delhi)	4,000 INR per night	1,200 INR per day	L&D Department Manager sign-off
Tier 2 Cities & Training Resorts	3,000 INR per night	1,000 INR per day	L&D Department Manager sign-off
International Training Hubs (Singapore, Dubai)	\$120 USD per night	\$60 USD per day	CFO & HR Director (Dual approval)